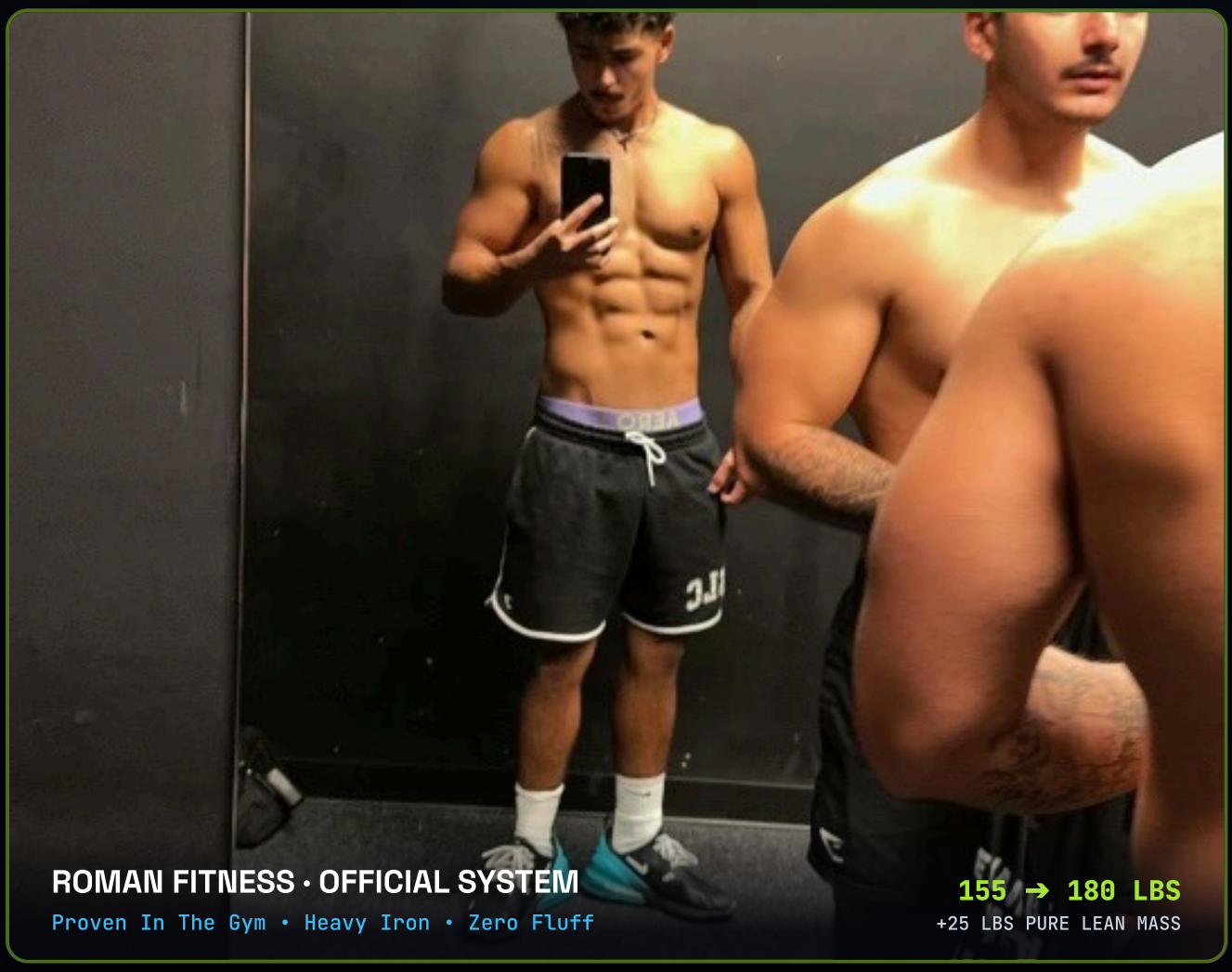
CREATED & ENGINEERED BY ROMAN

THE 155 ➔ 180 LBS HYPERTROPHY PROTOCOL

Roman's "2-Set Mechanical Failure & Progressive Overload" Master Blueprint



TRAINING METHOD	PROGRESSIVE RULE	CREATOR & COACH
2 Sets To Failure	**+5 lbs Load Jump**	**Roman**
RPE 10 / True Failure	Strict Double Progression	Master Hypertrophy Coach

Roman's Personal Directive:

"This is the exact, uncompromised blueprint designed to take you from **155 lbs slender to 180 lbs dense, vascular muscle** while keeping full 8-pack abs and sub-10% body fat. Most guys in the gym spend 2 hours doing 20 junk sets, texting on their phones, and wondering why their physique never changes. We don't do that here."

"Every exercise in this routine is executed for **exactly 2 working sets taken to absolute mechanical failure**. You track every rep and pound in your logbook. If you hit your rep ceiling on Set 1, you **add 5 lbs next week**. Eat in a calibrated surplus, nail your sleep, and execute with relentless intensity. Let's build a monster physique." — *Roman*

Visual Proof: 155 lbs Baseline vs. 180 lbs Shredded

Real results don't come from dirty bulking or bloated water retention. This protocol builds pure myofibrillar muscle density:



START: 155 LBS (BASELINE)



180 LBS (SHREDDED 8-PACK)



180 LBS (3D BOULDER DELTS)

The Science: Why 2 Failure Sets Demolish 20 Junk Sets

When you take a set to true mechanical failure (0 reps in reserve, involuntary slowing of bar speed), your central nervous system recruits **100% of high-threshold Type IIx muscle fibers**. Research proves that sets 1 and 2 deliver over 90% of the hypertrophic signaling. Sets 3, 4, and 5 only create systemic fatigue, joint inflammation, and elevated cortisol that delays recovery by days.

❌ 20 JUNK SET METHOD

- 2+ hours wasted in the gym
- Excess tendon & joint wear
- High cortisol, blunted testosterone
- Guessing weights without progression

✅ ROMAN'S 2-SET FAILURE PROTOCOL

- 45–50 minutes max workout density
- 100% high-threshold fiber stimulation
- Rapid CNS & muscular recovery
- Every pound logged & beaten weekly

⚡ The Golden Law: "Adding Weight IS Progressive Overload"

"If you bench 185 lbs for 8 reps today, and 6 months from now you still bench 185 lbs for 8 reps, you will look identical. The only stimulus that forces a muscle cell to expand is mechanical tension it has never felt before."

Your logbook is your contract with muscle growth. Every workout, your sole mission is to beat your previous numbers: either by **adding 5 lbs to the bar** or by fighting for 1 extra clean rep.

📐 The Double Progression Algorithm

Every exercise has an assigned **Rep Target Bracket** (e.g. 6–8 reps, or 8–10 reps). Here is the exact mathematical progression rule you must execute:

STEP 1: REPS FIRST

Pick a working weight where you hit failure at the bottom of the rep bracket (e.g., 185 lbs x 6 reps). Keep this weight until you can hit the top bracket (8 reps) with strict form.

STEP 2: ADD WEIGHT IMMEDIATELY

The moment Set 1 hits 8 clean reps, you **must add 5 lbs next week** (190 lbs). Your reps will naturally drop to 6 or 7. Build back up to 8. Repeat forever.

🔥 The Non-Fatiguing Warm-Up Ramping Protocol

Most lifters exhaust their glycogen on warm-up sets. Follow this strict 2-set ramp to prime your joints and nervous system without accumulating any metabolic fatigue:

WARM-UP PHASE	WEIGHT / LOAD	REPS	PURPOSE & OBJECTIVE
Warm-Up Set 1	50% of Working Weight	8 reps	Groove bar path, lubricate synovial joint capsule, warm tendons
Warm-Up Set 2	75% of Working Weight	3 reps	Prime central nervous system fire rate; zero muscle burn or fatigue
WORKING SET 1	100% Target Weight	**TO FAILURE**	`All-Out Effort` Maximum mechanical tension; log every rep
WORKING SET 2	100% Target Weight	**TO FAILURE**	Rest 2.5–3 min after Set 1; second all-out failure set to recruit remaining fibers

⏱️ Strict Tempo & Contraction Cues

3-SEC ECCENTRIC

Lower the weight under total control. The negative causes 80% of muscle micro-tears.

1-SEC STRETCH PAUSE

Dead stop at maximum stretch. Eliminates tendon bounce and forces muscle recruitment.

EXPLOSIVE DRIVE

Push through the concentric with maximum intent to ignite high-threshold motor units.

🔴 DAY 1: PUSH PROTOCOL (Chest, Shoulders, Triceps)

`2 SETS TO FAILURE ALL` 2 warm-up ramp sets on the first exercise only. Every working set is taken to absolute mechanical failure.

EXERCISE	TARGET MUSCLE	SETS	REPS	EXECUTION & FORM CUE
Flat Chest Press (DB or Machine)	Mid / Lower Pectorals	2 to Fail	6–8	3-sec descent, full chest stretch at bottom; drive elbows together at peak
Incline Chest Press (Smith / DB)	Upper Clavicular Pecs	2 to Fail	6–9	30° bench angle; tuck elbows 45°, drive up toward chin for upper chest shelf
Pec Deck Flye	Inner Sternal Pecs	2 to Fail	8–10	Soft elbow bend; squeeze pads together and hold contraction for 1 full second
DB Lateral Raises	Lateral Deltoid Head	2 to Fail	10–12	Lean forward 10°, lead with elbows; 5-sec isometric hold on the final rep
Cable Lateral Raises (Single Arm)	Constant Tension Delts	2 to Fail	10–12	Cable set at wrist height behind back; smooth continuous tension throughout
Skull Crushers (EZ Bar / DB)	Triceps Long Head	2 to Fail	8–10	Lower bar behind head (not forehead) for maximum stretch on the long head
Tricep Rope Pushdown	Lateral Triceps Horseshoe	2 to Fail	10–12	Flare rope outward at bottom lockout; keep elbows pinned to ribcage
Tricep Pushdown Bar	Heavy Overload Triceps	2 to Fail	6–8	Straight bar, lean slightly over bar, drive straight down with strict lockout

🔵 DAY 2: PULL PROTOCOL (Back, Rear Delts, Biceps)

`2 SETS TO FAILURE ALL` Initiate every pull by driving your elbows down and back into your hips, not by yanking with your forearms.

EXERCISE	TARGET MUSCLE	SETS	REPS	EXECUTION & FORM CUE
Lat Pulldowns (Neutral / Close)	Upper Lat Width / V-Taper	2 to Fail	8–10	Pull elbows straight down into back pockets; arch chest slightly to ceiling
Lat Pullovers (Cable / DB)	Lat Sweep Isolation	2 to Fail	10–12	Slight bend in elbows; sweep bar in a wide arcing motion down to thighs
T-Bar Row	Mid-Back & Rhomboid Meat	2 to Fail	6–8	45° hip hinge; pull to lower sternum, squeeze shoulder blades for 1 second
Unilateral Row Machine	Single-Side Lat Stretch	2 to Fail	8–10	Allow torso to rotate slightly forward on negative for extreme lat stretch
Hyperextensions	Spinal Erectors & Glutes	2 to Fail	10–12	Neutral spine; hold 45 lb plate across chest, squeeze erectors at top
Reverse Pec Deck	Rear Deltoid Head	2 to Fail	12–15	Drive knuckles outward in wide circle; do not pinch shoulder blades together
Cable Curl	Bicep Peak / Short Head	2 to Fail	8–10	Elbows pinned slightly in front of hips; full strict supination at top
Cable Hammer Curl (Rope)	Brachialis & Forearms	2 to Fail	10–12	Thumbs-up neutral grip; pushes bicep out for 3D arm thickness from front

🟢 DAY 3: LEGS PROTOCOL (Quads, Hamstrings, Adductors, Calves)

2 SETS TO FAILURE ALL Heavy leg training releases the highest systemic growth hormone response. Every set must be executed with full depth.

EXERCISE	TARGET MUSCLE	SETS	REPS	EXECUTION & FORM CUE
Hack Squat	Quad Teardrop & Sweep	2 to Fail	6–9	Feet low on platform for maximum knee flexion; 3-sec descent below parallel
Romanian Deadlifts (RDLs)	Hamstring Belly & Glutes	2 to Fail	8–10	Push hips straight back like touching a wall behind you; stop when hips stop
Hip Abductor Machine	Glute Medius / Hip Shelf	2 to Fail	12–15	Lean slightly forward; push knees wide apart, pause 1-sec at full spread
Hip Adductor Machine	Inner Thigh Density	2 to Fail	12–15	Slow controlled stretch on the negative; squeeze pads tight together
Leg Extension	Rectus Femoris Quad Peak	2 to Fail	10–12	Hold lockout at top for 1 full second; fight the eccentric descent down
Leg Curl (Lying or Seated)	Hamstring Peak	2 to Fail	8–10	Keep toes dorsiflexed; do not allow lower back or hips to buck off pad
Standing Calf Raises	Gastrocnemius Calf Meat	2 to Fail	12–15	2-sec dead stop at full bottom stretch; explode onto big toes at top

🟡 ABS PROTOCOL (3x Per Week, 2 Sets to Failure)

Thick, deeply etched 8-pack abs are built by loading abdominal flexion under resistance, not by doing 500 air crunches.

EXERCISE	TARGET AREA	SETS	TECHNIQUE & EXECUTION CUE
Cable / Decline Ab Crunches	Upper & Mid 8-Pack Core	2 to Fail	Round spine into tight ball; exhale all oxygen at peak crunch, 1-sec pause
Hanging / Captain's Chair Leg Raises	Lower Ab Pouch & Pelvis	2 to Fail	Do not swing legs; curl your pelvis UP toward your sternum on every single rep

🧠 CNS Recovery, Deep Sleep & Hydration Matrix

💤 7.5–8.5 HRS DEEP SLEEP MATRIX

Muscle protein synthesis peaks during Stage 3 slow-wave sleep when human growth hormone surges. 400mg Magnesium Glycinate 30 min before bed improves deep sleep latency and relaxes muscle cramping.

💧 1 GALLON WATER & ELECTROLYTES

Muscle tissue is 70% water. A 2% drop in hydration cuts muscular power by 15%. Drink 1 gallon of filtered water daily with 1/2 tsp pink Himalayan salt pre-workout for skin-splitting pumps.

🥩 The 155 ➔ 180 Lean Bulk Nutrition Blueprint

To gain 25 lbs of dense muscle without gaining waistline fat, maintain a controlled **+350 to +500 kcal caloric surplus**:

DAILY PROTEIN	COMPLEX CARBS	HEALTHY FATS
180g – 195g	**340g – 380g**	**65g – 75g**
Chicken, 93/7 beef, eggs, Greek yogurt, whey isolate	Jasmine rice, oats, sweet potatoes, cream of rice	Extra virgin olive oil, peanut butter, avocados, whole eggs

📓 Weekly Progressive Overload Gym Logbook Sheet

Print this sheet or log in your notes. **Your goal is to beat the previous week's numbers every single session.**

EXERCISE	WEEK 1 TARGET	WEEK 2 TARGET	WEEK 3 TARGET	WEEK 4 TARGET	PROGRESSION ACTION RULE
Flat Chest Press	185 lbs x 8	190 lbs x 6	190 lbs x 8	195 lbs x 6	**+5 lbs immediately upon hitting 8 reps**
Hack Squat	315 lbs x 8	325 lbs x 7	325 lbs x 9	335 lbs x 7	**+10 lbs upon hitting 9 deep reps**
T-Bar Row	135 lbs x 8	145 lbs x 7	145 lbs x 8	150 lbs x 7	**+5 lbs upon hitting 8 strict reps**
Incline Chest Press	155 lbs x 8	160 lbs x 7	160 lbs x 8	165 lbs x 6	**+5 lbs upon hitting 8 reps**
DB Lateral Raises	25 lbs x 12	25 lbs x 12+	30 lbs x 10	30 lbs x 12	**+5 lbs after 12 strict reps**

⚡ ROMAN'S EVIDENCE-BASED SUPPLEMENT PROTOCOL

ROMAN FITNESS

Skip the overpriced fat burners and proprietary blends. These 4 proven compounds maximize ATP power output, cell volumization, and overnight recovery:

1. Creatine Monohydrate (5g Daily)
Saturates intramuscular phosphocreatine stores to squeeze out 1–2 extra reps on heavy sets.

2. L-Citrulline (6g–8g Pre-Workout)
Maximizes nitric oxide vasodilation, nutrient delivery, and skin-splitting vascularity.